Launch Countdown

Every step from picking a launch date to the week after launch, with a do-by date for each so nothing important gets missed.

BUILDER | 30 MIN | PLAYBOOK: FIRST LAUNCH CHECKLIST

YOU WALK AWAY WITH
A launch date on your calendar, a checked-off countdown and your first real numbers, from who you asked to who bought and what stopped the rest.

USE IT
Build track week 3, about 14 days before you start asking people to pay, and every day through launch week.

A first launch is not a big event. It's the day you start asking people to pay. You launch to people who already know you, learn fast and fix what breaks.

Pick the date first. Deadlines turn plans into actions. The spreadsheet version fills in every do-by date from your launch date.

> Make today day one. The faster you fail, the faster you learn.

Your launch date

Launch day

About 14 days from today. Put it on your calendar with reminders.

The three people checking in on you

Text them the date today.

Today

DO BY 14 DAYS BEFORE LAUNCH

- [ ] Pick a launch date about 14 days out and put it on your calendar.
- [ ] Text three people the date and ask them to check in on you.
- [ ] Copy this countdown into Google Sheets, Notion or your notes app.

Two weeks before: set up the foundation

DO BY 8 DAYS BEFORE LAUNCH

- [ ] Finish your One-Page Offer.
- [ ] Fill in your Landing Page Brief and build the page.
- [ ] Run the five-point pre-launch check on your phone.
- [ ] Set up payments: Shopify Payments for a store, or a payment link for a service.
- [ ] Make a real payment with your own card, then refund it.
- [ ] Look into registering your business. Check your local rules or ask a professional. This isn't legal or tax advice.

- [ ] Set up a separate way to track business money. See Before You Take Money.
- [ ] Write your delivery steps: everything that happens after someone pays.
- [ ] Do one full test delivery with a friend.

One week before: warm up your list

DO BY 1 DAY BEFORE LAUNCH

- [ ] Write your warm list in the Pipeline Tracker. Aim for 30 names.
- [ ] Mark the 10 people most likely to buy.
- [ ] Send those 10 a personal heads-up and ask if you can send them the link first.
- [ ] Post once about what you're building and why.
- [ ] Draft your launch post, your launch DM and your launch story.
- [ ] Write the welcome message every new customer gets.
- [ ] Write your three feedback questions.
- [ ] Open the Objection Log so you can capture every "but" during launch week.

Launch day

DO ON LAUNCH DAY

- [ ] Send personal DMs to your top 10. One at a time, never a group message.
- [ ] Post your launch post and your story.
- [ ] Reply to every comment and DM the same day.
- [ ] Log every reply and sale in the Pipeline Tracker.

Day 2

DO BY 1 DAY AFTER LAUNCH

- [ ] Message the next 20 people on your warm list.
- [ ] Ask your day 1 buyers if they know one person who'd want this.

Day 3

DO BY 2 DAYS AFTER LAUNCH

- [ ] Post something useful about the problem you solve, like a before and after or a quick tip.
- [ ] Log every objection you've heard so far in the Objection Log.

Day 4

DO BY 3 DAYS AFTER LAUNCH

- [ ] Send one short, friendly follow-up to every maybe and every no-reply.

Day 5

DO BY 4 DAYS AFTER LAUNCH

- [ ] Deliver to your first customers with extra care. Over-deliver on the first orders.

Day 6

DO BY 5 DAYS AFTER LAUNCH

- [ ] Post a real update: what happened and what you learned.
- [ ] Share a customer result only with their permission.

Day 7

DO BY 6 DAYS AFTER LAUNCH

- [ ] Count messages sent, replies, sales and objections.
- [ ] Write down the one thing you'll change next week.

The week after: ask, learn, decide

DO BY 13 DAYS AFTER LAUNCH

- [ ] Thank every customer within three days of delivery.
- [ ] Ask every customer: What almost stopped you from buying? What was the best part? What would you change?
- [ ] Ask happy customers if you can share their words or a photo. Use only what they approve.
- [ ] Ask every non-buyer: What would have made it a yes?
- [ ] Update your FAQ and landing page from the Objection Log.
- [ ] Find the message, post or person that drove the most sales, and ask why it worked.
- [ ] Pick one thing to do more of next week.
- [ ] Set up simple revenue and expense tracking, and ask a professional about taxes where you live.

Launch day messages

HEADS-UP DM (ONE WEEK BEFORE) COPY

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Hey [name], I'm launching [thing] next [day]. It helps [who] [get result]. You're one of the first people I thought of. Can I send you the link before I post it?
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LAUNCH-DAY DM COPY

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Hey [name], it's live. [One line on what it is and who it's for]. [Price, framed small]. Here's the link: [link]. If it's not for you, no stress. Do you know one person it might help?
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WEEK-AFTER THANK YOU COPY

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Hey [name], thank you for being one of my first customers. It means a lot. Three quick questions so I can make it better: What almost stopped you from buying? What was the best part? What would you change?
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Keep it clean

> Only promise delivery times you've already tested. If you mess up, say so fast and fix it. No fake scarcity, no made-up reviews. Your first ten customers will tell people how you treated them.

Next step

After day 7, set up your Weekly Founder Scorecard and enter your launch week numbers. They are your baseline.

Make today day one.

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